BINTI RISING INITIATIVE · A PHOTOGRAPHIC MONOGRAPH NAIROBI · MMXXVI

From Silence,
She Rises.

In Kibera, Mathare and Kawangware, the Binti Rising Initiative runs a peer-led mentorship programme — the Journey to Wholeness — for adolescent girls and young women aged 15 to 25. This monograph follows one arc through fourteen photographs from the Nairobi team's own camera roll: circle, classroom, voice, craft, proof, rise.

PEER-LED · JOURNEY TO WHOLENESS (JTW) · AGES 15–25 ·
KIBERA — MATHARE — KAWANGWARE · DPA 2019 COMPLIANT

I. THE CIRCLE

Nothing begins with a lesson.

It begins with a circle — hands joined, names said aloud, the day's fears set in the middle where everyone can see them. Peer mentors lead; adults hold the space. Attendance across the three communities runs at ninety per cent and above, but the truer metric is simpler: they come back.

Plate 01 · Under the community tent, hands meet in a closed circle — where every Journey to Wholeness begins.

Plate 11 · A dialogue circle in a community hall: no podium, no stage — only peers.

II. THE CLASSROOM

The work moves through classrooms and halls.

One week it is letters and stories on a chalkboard; the next, a conversation about the body, consent and health that the syllabus never scheduled. Sessions are built for 15-to-25-year-olds — old enough to be trusted with the truth.

Read the story
There was a giraffe
Answer questions
1. There was a
2. He was very

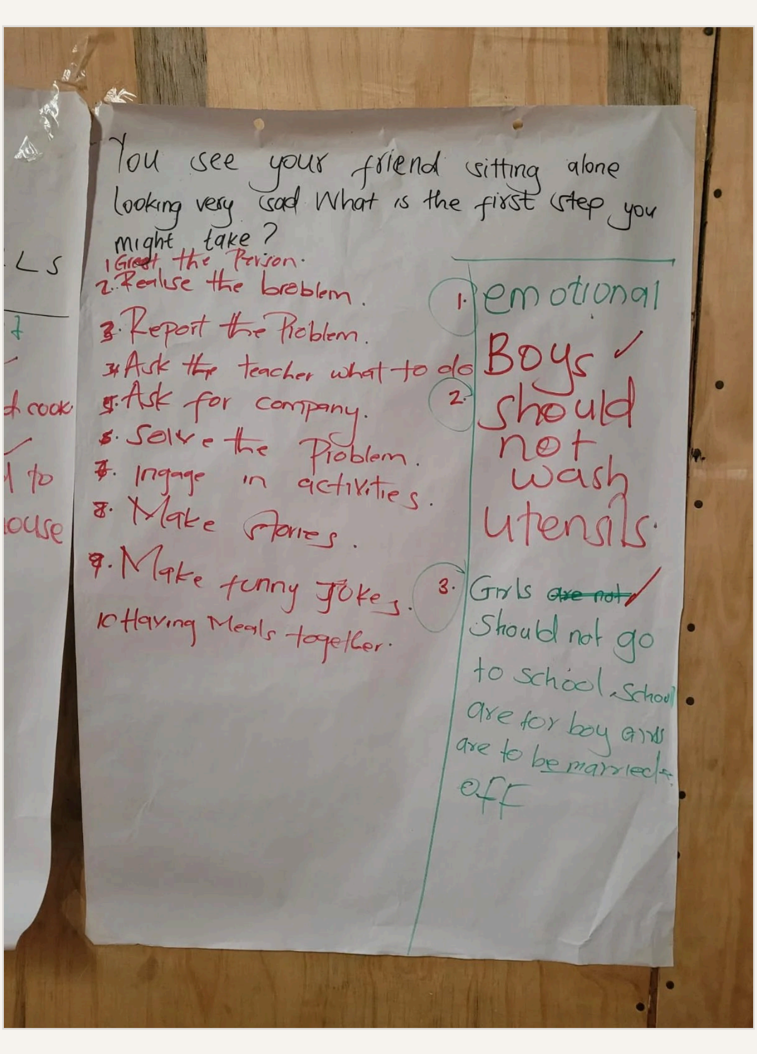
Plate 02 · A classroom session in motion — learners count the rhythm, alphabets on the wall, questions in the air.

III. THE VOICE

> ~~“Girls are to be married off.”~~
>
> READ ALOUD — THEN STRUCK THROUGH, TOGETHER. SESSION FLIPCHART, PLATE 08.

On a paper flipchart, myths die in public. Facilitators write down what the street says; the circle answers back, line by line — ten steps to help a friend, myths crossed out in marker. When a girl takes the charts and stands, the session changes owners. That is precisely the point of a peer-led model.

Plate 07 · A girl takes the flipcharts and stands. In JTW circles, the facilitator's chair moves aside for her.



You see your friend sitting alone looking very sad What is the first step you might take?

1 Greet the Person.
2. Realise the broblem.
3. Report the Problem.
4. Ask the teacher what to do
5. Ask for company.
6. Solve the Problem.
7. Ingage in activities.
8. Make stories.
9. Make funny Jokes.
10 Having Meals together.

1. emotional
2. Boys should not wash utensils.
3. Girls ~~are not~~ Should not go to school. School are for boy girls are to be married off

Plate 08 · The flipchart records the work: ten steps to reach a friend who is struggling — and the myths, struck through one by one.

IV. THE CRAFT & THE TEAM

Between circles, hands stay busy.

Crayon on paper. A film afternoon. Handball drills. Comics that teach in the street's own language. Sport, art and story are not decoration here — they are how hard lessons get practised, rehearsed and remembered.

Plate 05 · A flame takes colour. Healing often starts in the hands.

Plate 12 · A screening afternoon — the film slows the room down; the discussion after it lasts longer.

VISION
Dignified, safe, just and empowered communities
MISSION
Congratulations
OLYMPIC HANDBALL TEAM
SSK, MTV SHUGA, SHUJAAZ

Plate 10 · The handball squad lines up before the board that reads *Congratulations* — on the wall behind them, a vision: “Dignified, safe, just and empowered communities.”

SHUJAAZ
YOUNG KINGS SA
SURROUND SOUND KENYA

Plate 13 · Young Kings SA with their Shujaaz magazines — stories that carry health messages in the language of the street.

V. THE PROOF

Then the corridor becomes a stage.

Certificates — co-signed by partners like MTV Shuga, PATH and Shujaaz — move from table to hand to wall. In February 2026, one school lifted a whole cohort's certificates at once. The photos do not show charity; they show completion.

Plate 03 · Certificates of Achievement — and the pride that travels with them.

Plate 04 · A handshake, a certificate, a next step.

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT
shuga
PATH

Plate 06 · Certificates held high in a settlement walkway — the corridor becomes a graduation hall.

2026/02/19 18:55
Nairobi, Kenya
Enter text

Plate 09 · Nairobi, February 2026 — a whole school lifts its certificates at once.

Coda SHE RISES

SCHOOL MOTTO:
"KNOWLEDGE IS POWER"

Plate 14 · Beneath the motto “Knowledge is Power”, the group closes its story the way it opened it — together, fists raised.

From silence, she rises — but not alone, and not once. Every term the circle opens again, in Kibera, in Mathare, in Kawangware. The fists come up. The motto above them says what the programme believes.

1,248
YOUTH ENROLLED
FY-2025/26 AGGREGATE

3
COMMUNITIES
KIBERA · MATHARE · KAWANGWARE

90–95%
ATTENDANCE
ACROSS SESSIONS

61 → 77
WELLBEING INDEX
SIX-MONTH AVERAGE

Plates. All fourteen photographs are the initiative's own archive (*public/nairobi-team/*, traceable via *manifest.json* to the Nairobi team's Google Drive folder). Published under the Nairobi photo rule — no stock imagery, no substitutes. Tagged **nairobi-photos-v1.0** · github.com/collins-muchiri/binti-rising-website

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